

ASSESSMENT TOOL-3

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COURSE CODE: ITA1407

- ① A 16 year old finds a flaw in their school's grading portal and quietly emails the administration instead of exploiting it. Classify this individual using standard hacker categorizations and justify your reasoning.

The 16-year old student be classified as a White-Hat Hacker because they demonstrated responsible and ethical behavior after discovering a security vulnerability in the school's grading portal. Instead of taking advantage of the flaw to change grades, access confidential information, or share the vulnerability with others, the student privately informed the school administration, giving them the opportunity to fix the issue before it could be exploited.

White hat hackers use their technical knowledge to identify security weaknesses and help organizations improve their systems. Their actions are guided by ethical principles such as honesty, responsibility, and respect for privacy. Although the student may not have been formally authorized to test the grading portal, their decision to report the flaw.

Justification:

* The student discovered a security vulnerability but did not exploit it

* They reported the flaw privately to the school administration instead of making it public

* Their intention was to help improve the security of the grading portal rather than gain personal benefit

* They acted with integrity, responsibility, and respect for other's data

* Their actions align with the principles of ethical hacking and responsible disclosure.

Conclusion:

The individual is best classified as a white hat hacker because they used their technical skills responsibly and ethically. By choosing to report the vulnerability instead of exploiting it, they helped protect the school's grading system and demonstrated the core values of ethical cybersecurity professionals.